

Pictures, we decided, could be clicked only when in PDA mode, using the 5-megapixel camera-PDA mode offered the best area for the LCD viewfinder.

Someone pointed out that we needed to think of what would happen if you got a call when in PDA mode, so we decided that the calling number would blink on one corner of the screen, and you could choose to either switch back to phone mode or just take the call using your Bluetooth headset. Simple, huh?

That done, we now had to figure out a way of cramming a tablet PC into this device. Easier said than done: we had no space to work with. "What about the length?" someone asked. "What about it?" "Well, 140 mm isn't bad for a monitor's width, settle for a small display... better than nothing." OK. So GOD would flip open on a hinge attached along its length—much like Nokia's Communicator series. The whole inside face would be made of a foldable display.

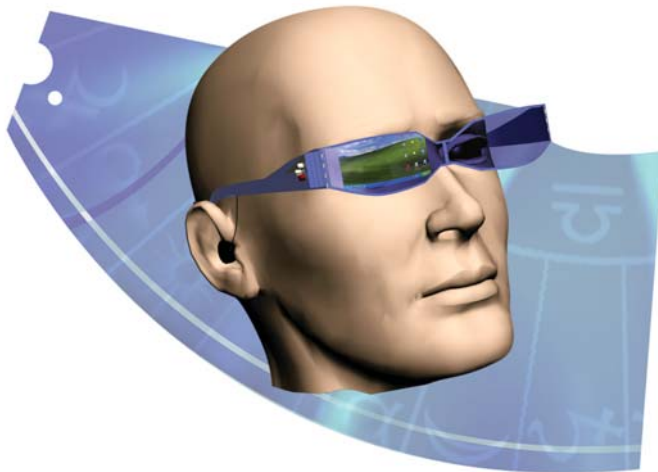
When half flipped open, GOD would function as a laptop, again using one half of the display as a virtual keyboard, and the other as a 140 x 100 mm screen. Somewhat like a tablet PC in laptop mode. In order to convert GOD to full tablet mode, all you need to do is open it up fully, at which point, GOD automatically converts to a 200 x 140 mm tablet PC—switching display orientation.

We had our share of arguments, especially over the small display when in laptop mode. One other option that seemed to make sense was not to have an intermediate laptop mode (with GOD flipped half open). Instead, use Bluetooth-enabled eyewear to project a virtual screen, and use GOD's internal touchscreen display as a keyboard instead. This would keep users from having to squint to find icons on the tiny desktop! It's already possible—there were no drawbacks in terms of technology.

We decided that GOD was, well GOD, and could do all the above. Besides, we now got to include a cool pair of virtual display goggles in the bundled accessories! Apart from the odd dreamer-geek who screamed for a 3D holographic display, most of us were satisfied with the results.



When GOD is opened, it converts into a decent sized tablet PC (200 x 140 mm). When opened, it can also be used as a keyboard along with the virtual display eyewear



The representation of a pair of virtual display spectacles shown here are not really far-fetched. In fact, they already come in all shapes, sizes and display resolutions! We're just predicting that they'll be designed to look cooler and become a fad!

That was about it. We had included everything we could think of, and it didn't take us more than a few hours—if only production lines were as easy to calibrate as our imaginations!

GOD In A Box

Now that we'd made GOD, we needed to package it, and that included a specification list. Here's what we came up with:

Hardware

2 GHz CPU
250 GB non-volatile RAM/HDD
X850 XT/6800 GT GFx
100 x 150 front OLED touchscreen display
240 x 160 internal OLED foldable touchscreen display

Software Bundle

Windows / Linux Tablet PC OS
Handwriting recognition
Driver CD

Features

128-channel polyphonic ringtones
Bluetooth / Wi-Fi / Gigabit Ethernet
5-megapixel digital / Web camera
Unlimited address book / SMS / MMS storage
Palm / PocketPC functionality
And much more...

As for GOD's price, we decided people would definitely be willing to pay even up to \$5,000 (Rs 2,20,000) for this dream gadget. So the price was set to Rs 2 lakh.

Back To Reality

Every good thing has to end sometime, but as we reached the end of this article, we decided that our dream hadn't ended... in fact, it was just beginning—thanks to some great work being done by research labs and scientists around the world.

The reason we kept it believable—imagining only the use of technologies that exist, or, at most, are under development—is because GOD is not fictional! The thought that within a few years from now, we could be testing gadgets like GOD in a shootout for our readers is what makes our jobs—nay, our lives—worthwhile. ■

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